The Islamia University of Bahawalpur
Department of Information Technology

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**E-Commerce Application Development**

Appendix

# E

# Where to Read Further

**Taught in** —

**Laboratory** —

**Assessment** —

**This is a class extract.** It is *Appendix E* of the unified handout, printed on its own so that a week's reading is a week's reading. Page numbers restart at 1 and are local to this extract; chapter, figure and table numbers are the ones the full volume gives them, so a reference you follow here lands in the same place there.

Cross-references to other chapters print as their numbers in the full volume. For the whole course in one file — front matter, the HEC tracing table, all twenty-three chapters and all seven appendices — see `ECAD_Fall2026_Handout.pdf`.

Chapter E

# Where to Read Further

HEC's outline for this course lists four reference books. Three of them are cited at editions that are now between nine and nineteen years old, and one teaches a runtime that lost security support in 2018. This appendix records what HEC prescribed, what this course used instead, and — in each case — why, so that a reviewer can see that the substitution was made deliberately rather than by neglect.

## E.1 What HEC Prescribed

| Reference, as HEC lists it | Edition | Status |
|---|---|---|
| Laudon & Traver, *E-Commerce: Business, Technology, Society* | 13th, 2017 | Still the standard text; much newer editions exist |
| **Peacock, *PHP 5 E-commerce Development*** | 2010 | **Targets a runtime unsupported since 2018** |
| Rayport & Jaworski, *Introduction to E-Commerce* | 2007 | Predates the mobile web |
| Schneider, *Electronic Commerce* | — | Current editions exist |

**On the Peacock book, which is the interesting one**

It is listed as reference 2, and **the "Course Content" paragraph of HEC's outline is that book's table of contents**, nearly verbatim and in order. That finding is recorded in the Course Specification at the front of this handout, and it explains a great deal: why the clause list reads like a build sequence, why "Checkout" appears twice, and why gift vouchers are named (Chapter 12 found the platform has none — they were a feature of the 2010 cart the book builds).

**Why this course does not follow it.** PHP 5 reached end of life on 31 December 2018 and has received no security fix since. Teaching a 2010 cart on a dead runtime would mean teaching, as current practice, patterns that are now vulnerabilities — unprepared queries, `mysql_*` functions, MD5 password hashing. Chapter 15 measured what this platform does instead.

**It is still worth half an hour of your time.** Read its contents page beside HEC's clause list, and you will understand how a curriculum outline is made, which is a more useful lesson than anything in the chapters.

## E.2 What This Course Used Instead

**Business and models — Chapter 1 to Chapter 4**

- **Laudon & Traver**, *E-Commerce: Business, Technology, Society*, **current edition**. The same book HEC names, read at an edition that knows about mobile commerce and marketplaces. Its business-model taxonomy is what Chapter 2 is organised around.
- **Pakistan Bureau of Statistics** and the **State Bank of Pakistan**'s payment system reviews, for market figures. Prefer a primary statistic you can cite to a number from a blog post.

### The platform — Chapter 5 to Chapter 18

- **OpenCart's own documentation** at `docs.opencart.com`, and, more usefully, **its source**. This handout read the source for every claim it makes about behaviour, because the documentation is thin and in several places describes an older version.
- **The MariaDB Knowledge Base** for `EXPLAIN`, the slow query log and index behaviour — Chapter 6's method comes from it.
- **The Docker documentation** on Compose, volumes and healthchecks. Chapter 5 and Chapter 9 rest on the volume semantics it defines.
- **The PHP manual** on `password_hash` and sessions. It is unusually good and is the primary source for Chapter 15.

### Security — Chapter 16

- **OWASP Top Ten** — the list everyone cites. Read it to know the vocabulary, then note that Chapter 16 measured the two most famous entries as already handled by the framework.
- **OWASP Application Security Verification Standard (ASVS)** — far more useful than the Top Ten for actual work, because it is a checklist of requirements at three levels rather than a ranking of fashionable attacks.
- **OWASP Secure Headers Project**, which is where this course's `security.conf` comes from.
- **PCI DSS and the SAQ-A questionnaire**, from the PCI Security Standards Council. Chapter 14 summarises it; read the actual questionnaire once, because it is shorter than its reputation.
- **Mozilla Developer Network** on Content Security Policy, which is the clearest writing on the subject anywhere.

### Law and policy — Chapter 22

Primary sources only. Secondary summaries of Pakistani e-commerce law are frequently out of date and occasionally wrong about which tier of government is responsible.

- **Electronic Transactions Ordinance 2002** — what makes an online order enforceable.
- **Prevention of Electronic Crimes Act 2016** — read sections 3 and 4 before Chapter 16's laboratory, not after.
- **E-Commerce Policy of Pakistan (Ministry of Commerce, 2019)** — the policy framework, and short enough to read in one sitting.
- **The provincial consumer protection Acts** — Punjab (2005), Sindh (2014), Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, Balochistan. Read the one your shop is in.
- **Federal Board of Revenue** for the current sales tax position, and the **Finance Act** of the year in question for the rate. Chapter 11 deliberately refuses to be the authority for a number set annually.

### How to read any of this

1. **Prefer the primary source.** The manual, the standard, the Act. Every secondary account of them in this handout can be checked against one.
2. **Prefer the source you can run.** `EXPLAIN` beats an article about indexes; the shop's own code beats its documentation. This is the method of the whole course.
3. **Date everything.** A rate, a version, an end-of-life date and a statutory limit all expire. A claim with no date is a claim you cannot check.

4. **Distrust anything about ranking, conversion or performance that comes without a method.** Chapter 21 declined to make claims it could not check, and the same standard applies to what you read.

## E.3 A Note on Using Tutorials

Most of what you will find searching for this platform was written for version 1.5 or 3.x and does not apply. Two findings from this course make the point sharply:

- **"Rename `.htaccess.txt`"** is in every guide, and Chapter 16 measured it as doing nothing at all on a modern Apache where `AllowOverride` is `None`. The advice has been repeated for fifteen years and has quietly stopped being true.
- **"Turn on SEO URLs"** is in every guide, and Chapter 21 measured that doing so — without the server-side rewrite the same guides assume is present — points *every link in the shop* at a 404.

**Neither piece of advice was ever wrong. Both stopped being right without anybody updating them.** That is the normal fate of written advice about software, and it is why this course measures rather than cites. Read tutorials for the idea; verify the behaviour in your own container.